

Team Worksheet — Lab 1

Select and Charter Your Capstone Project

Team members: _____

Date: _____

1. Our understanding of the problem

2. Our working

Use the data in `lab-01-project-selection-and-charter.xlsx`.

3. What we produced

Deliverable: A scored project selection matrix and a signed-off capstone project charter.

4. What the evidence does NOT tell us

5. Our conclusion

6. Step notes

Step 1. Choose your capstone process. Strongly preferred: a real process from your own workplace where you can obtain data. Fallback: the Meridian Medical Devices scenario.

Step 2. List at least five candidate improvement projects within that process or business area. Write each as a PROBLEM, never as a solution.

Step 3. Build a project selection matrix. Score each candidate 1-5 on: strategic fit, annualised financial benefit, data availability, scope manageability, sponsor commitment and technical risk.

Step 4. Weight the criteria — strategic fit and financial benefit usually carry the highest weight — and compute a weighted total for each candidate.

Step 5. Reject any candidate that is a solution in disguise ('deploy a new MES'), has no accessible data, or has no named sponsor. Record WHY each was rejected.

Step 6. Select your capstone project — the highest weighted score that survives the rejection filters.

Step 7. Estimate the Cost of Poor Quality for the selected project: scrap, rework, warranty, expedite, lost margin and capacity consumed. Annualise it.

Step 8. Write the charter: business case, problem statement, goal statement (SMART), scope (in/out), preliminary Y, team, sponsor, milestones and expected benefit.

Step 9. Write your problem statement to the four-part test: the process, the time period, the measurable gap and the business impact — with no cause and no solution in it.

Step 10. Identify your sponsor and record what you need from them. Where possible, obtain real sign-off before Day 2.

7. Self-check

You have a weighted selection matrix with at least five scored candidates, a documented rejection rationale, an annualised COPQ figure, and a complete charter whose problem statement contains no cause and no solution.

Complete? ■ Yes ■ Not yet

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